Greek ἔπω and Indo-European **sep-*

§ 1. Greek ἔπω is traditionally glossed with meanings like 'busy oneself with, deal with, tend to', and said to be cognate with Vedic *sápati* 'venerates, tends' (together with other Indo-Iranian material, treated below). These forms in turn are reducible to an Indo-European root **sep-*, glossed 'care for, revere, honor' and the like.[1] In addition to ἔπω and Vedic *sápati*, another derivative is seen in Ved. *saparyáti*, which again means 'honors, venerates', and which is formally identical to Latin *sepeliō* 'I bury'; according to this account, *sepeliō* must originally have meant **'I honor (i.e. with burial rites)'.[2]

§ 2. In point of fact, the semantic relationship between ἔπω (allegedly 'deal with, tend to, be involved in' etc.) and Ved. *sápati* (basically 'honors') has never been very clear. As it happens, the Indo-Iranian material reveals certain embarrassing semantic facts that cannot easily be reconciled with the standard interpretation of Indo-European **sep-*.

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[1] Cf. Pokorny, IEW. p.909: "*sep-* 'sich mit etwas abgeben, in Ehren halten'".

[2] Thus Pokorny's lemma continues: "*sep-el-* 'Sorge, Ehrfurcht': dazu idg. *sepeli̯ō* in *saparyáti* 'veneratur', *sepeliō* 'begraben', d.i. 'venerari sepulcro'"; similarly Ernout-Meillet, Dict. s.v. *sepeliō*: "*sepeliō* se serait dit par spécialisation des honneurs rendus à un mort". The treatment of ἔπω in LSJ., including the etymological notice, is quite representative: "ἔπω: 'to be about, busy oneself with'–compare Skt. *sapati* 'worship, tend', *saparyati* 'worship, honor', Lat. *sepeliō* 'give funeral honors'". The archaic (and false) notion that ἔπω is merely the active counterpart of ἕπομαι, or that *sap-* is a "Nebenform" of *sac-* (see e.g. Bopp, Vergl. Gr.[2] p.244; Curtius, Grundzüge 2, p.47–48; Vaníček, Griech.-Lat. Wb. 1, p.982; Grassmann, Wb. Sp.1472); need not concern us, except insofar as it contributed to a basic misconception about the meaning of ἔπω, i.e. that ἔπω is at least partly a verb of motion (explicitly in Capelle, Vollst. Wb.[9] p.225–26: "Grundbed. 'in Bewegung sein, geschäftig sein'"): to move about here and there, engaging in various activities, undefined in nature. For possible confusions between ἔπω and ἕπομαι already in the text of Homer, see Chantraine, Gramm. hom. 1, p.308–09, 388.

For Ved. *sápati* (RV. 14 ×), there is good evidence for quite physical meanings like 'touch', 'handle', or 'caress', as Geldner has already demonstrated (Ved. Stud. 2, p.134–35 and 3, p.179). Citing native commentators' vacillation between *pari-car-* (also *arc-, sam-ava-i-*) and *spṛś-* (also *pra-āp-*) in their explanations of Ved. passages with *sap-*,[3] Geldner concluded that "Der Begriff von *sap* liegt in der Mitte von *spṛś* und *pari-car.* Es bedeutet: liebkosen, schmeicheln, umwerben, rühren; pflegen (*ṛtáṃ sap*), engl. to touch und to cherish".[4]

In his earlier note on *sap-*, Geldner had already compared the *spṛś-* interpretations of *sap-* with its Gathic Avestan cognate *hap-*, which at Y. 43.4 can only mean 'hold': *hiiaṯ tā zastā / yā tū hafšī auuå // yå då ašīš* "... if Thou shalt help me (now) with the very hand with which Thou dost hold these rewards (which ...)" (Insler).[5] The close connection between Ved. *sap-* and Av. *hap-* is apparent, moreover, from the strong parallel associations *sap-* + *ṛtá-* / *hap-* + *aša-*, as Geldner and others have noticed. For Av., note the second occurrence of *hap-*, Y. 31.22: *vohū huuō xšaθrā aṣəm / vacaŋhā šiiaoθanācā haptī*,[6] as well as Y. 43.4, cited in part above, which continues with the phrases *drəguuaitē aṣaunaēcā* "to the deceitful and the truthful" and

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[3] E.g. Sāyaṇa: *pari-car-* for 4.4.9, 5.43.12, 6.15.10, 7.38.5, 7.83.8, but *spṛś-* for 5.3.4 (here also Yāska *spṛśati*), 5.12.2, 9.97.37, and both offered as possibilities for 6.29.1; cf. also *samavayantaḥ spṛśanto vā* 1.67.8, *samavayantaḥ, prāpnuvanta ity arthaḥ* 1.68.4, *paricaraṇākhyena karmaṇā spṛśantaḥ* 2.11.12, and note Mahīdhara on VS. 37.20, *sapema* : *maithunāya tvām upaspṛśāmaḥ.*

[4] See especially Ved. Stud. 2, p.135 for discussion of the frequent erotic connotations of *sap-*.

[5] Note *tā zastā* 'with the hand'; cf. *sápanti ... suhástāḥ* in RV. 9.97.37 *sápanti yám mithunáso nikāmā | adharyávo rathirásaḥ suhástāḥ* "[Soma,] den die ergebenen Paare pflegen, die Adhvaryu's, die handfertigen Wagenfahrer" (Geldner). RV. *súhasta-* (12×) regularly (5×) describes the Ṛbhus in their capacity as charioteers (see Macdonell, Ved. Mythol. p.131–32); but its use with the Adhvaryus is more varied: in addition to 9.97.37, note 10.30.2, referring to the Adhvaryus' dexterity in bringing the sacred waters (*tám ásyadhvam ūrmím adyā súhastāḥ*), as well as *suhástya-* in 10.41.3, referring to their manual skill, as Soma-priests, in handling the sacred drink (*adhvaryúm ... mádhupāṇim suhástyam*).

[6] Here with a less physical sense of 'hold': "He serves truth" (Insler), cf. Bartholomae "er stützt", or Eng. *uphold.*

aθrō aṣ̌ā.aojaŋhō "(through the heat) of thy truth-strong fire" (Insler). In the Rig-Veda, *sápati* is associated with *ṛtá-* in six of its fourteen occurrences; note especially 5.68.4, which begins *ṛtám ṛténa sápante,* and 5.12.2, in which *ṛtá-* occurs no less than four times, including the phrase *ṛtám sapāmy.*[7] Note also the Ved. compound *ṛtasắp-* (RV. 7 ×, always nom. pl. *ṛtasắpas*), to which Geldner compares Ved. *ṛtaspṛ́ś-* (Ved. Stud. 3, p. 179 n. 1).

In addition to *ṛtasắp-,* the following derivatives of *sap-* also occur in Vedic:

1. RV. *sápti-* 'team (of horses); horse', which Mayrhofer (s. v.) associates with the GAv. collocation *tā zastā ... hap-* 'hold with the hand', further comparing Ved. *dhúr-* (a wagon-part) and Lat. *frēnum* 'bridle', which may likewise be from a root (**dherh$_{\chi}$-*) meaning simply 'hold'.

2. RV. *niṣṣapín-* (1.104.5), which seems to mean 'squandering, spendthrift',[8] requiring a physical sense 'let go' (or "unhold", as it were) for *nis + sap-*.[9]

3. Ved. *sápa-* (TB., MS. etc.) 'penis', whose meaning, according to Mayrhofer, is related to the erotic overtones of *sápati* in meanings like 'touch, caress'.[10]

4. RV. *ketasắpaḥ* (5.38.3), which seems to mean 'willing' or 'obedient'; to be sure, this form is perhaps easier derived from meanings like 'honor' or 'respect' ('respecting the will'), although Sāyaṇa again paraphrases with *spṛ́śantaḥ.*

On balance, then, the Indo-Iranian evidence strongly suggests that the verb incorporates a physical sense of 'holding' or

[7] This hymn can be added to those in which *ṛtá-* is repeated throughout as a key word, often with anaphora, discussed by C. Watkins, Ériu 30 (1979) p. 182ff., with n. 14.

[8] *mā́ no maghéva niṣṣapí párā dāḥ* "gib uns nicht preis wie der Verschwender seine Reichtümer!" (Geldner).

[9] To my knowledge, the meaning of this form has hitherto remained unexplained; the interpretation *sensu obscoeno* (see e.g. Monier-Williams, Dict. s.v.: 'libidinous, lustful'), suggested by Sāyaṇa's somewhat rambling remarks (ad loc.) on *sápa-* (see below), *pásas-, śépa-* and other forms, does not suit the RV. context.

[10] But see Mayrhofer, s.v., for other possibilities, including relationship with *pásas-* and *śépa-*; cf. the preceding note.

'touching'. But such concrete meanings of Ved. *sap-* and GAv. *hap-* – which are clearly of IIr. date – match neither the meaning of Gk. ἔπω (as generally understood), nor the alleged meaning of IE. **sep-,* and must apparently be taken as an IIr. innovation. This is not, however, an attractive hypothesis. Although the relationship of 'hold' or 'touch' or 'caress' to more abstract meanings like 'uphold, support, protect, cherish, honor' could in theory be conceived in various ways, by far the most natural and best-documented development, for these semantic fields, involves concrete to abstract progressions ('hold' > 'uphold' etc.), despite rare counterexamples.[11]

§ 3. The framework of a solution for this dilemma was provided a century ago by Walter Leaf,[12] whose thorough evaluation of the meaning of ἔπω – undertaken independently of the IIr. material – concluded that ἔπω originally meant simply 'handle', a meaning still visible in a number of its Homeric usages (as well as in e.g. ὅπλον, generally 'tool, implement, gear' in Homer, and only later specialized as 'weapon'). Thus in Il. 6. 321 – the only instance of ἔπω without preverb, whether in composition or with tmesis – Hector finds Paris irresolutely *handling* his armor, prior to his decision to return to battle:

> τὸν δ' εὗρ' ἐν θαλάμῳ περικάλλεα τεύχε' *ἕποντα,*
> ἀσπίδα καὶ θώρηκα, καὶ ἀγκύλα τόξ' ἀφόωντα[13]

Note also Achilles' famous words, Il. 1.165–6:

> ... τὸ μὲν πλεῖον πολυάϊκος πολέμοιο
> *χεῖρες ἐμαι διέπουσι.*

where "the specific mention of the hands is significant of the origin of the phrase, which is hardly felt as a metaphor" (Leaf, op. cit. p. 237). In other prominent Homeric usages, ἀμφέπω regularly appears in formulas referring to "the various operations, such as taking out the entrails and cutting off the superfluous parts, which preceded the actual cutting up and spitting

[11] E.g. Eng. *caress,* from the Italian abstract *carezza* 'tenderness'.

[12] "ἔπειν and ἕπεσθαι", Journal of Philology 14 (1885) p. 231–251.

[13] The parallel ἀφόωντα also occurs nowhere else without preverb; of 'handling' armor, also Il. 15.555 οὐχ' ὁράας οἷον Δόλοπος περὶ τεύχε' ἕπουσι.

of that which had to be cooked",[14] while μεθέπω and ἐφέπω regularly refer to managing or guiding horses.[15]

Despite Leaf's thorough and convincing demonstration, his findings are ignored by or unknown to the etymological dictionaries of Prellwitz, Boisacq, Hofmann, Frisk and Chantraine.[16] These findings, however, clearly provide an important and welcome parallel to the IIr. facts in § 2, forcing a revision of the traditional understanding of IE. **sep-*, which can now be taken to have meant rather 'handle (skillfully), hold (reverently)' or the like, and not 'tend to, deal with; honor' etc.[17]

§ 4. This reanalysis implies that the relationship between Ved. *saparyáti* and Lat. *sepeliō* (which, like that between *sápati* and ἕπω, has always been semantically unsatisfying)[18] is also to be understood somewhat differently.

[14] Op. cit. 236; thus ἀμφὶ βοὸς ἕπετον κρέα Il. 11.776, cf. βοῦν ... ἄμφεπον Il. 18.559; βοῦς/ὄϊν ... ἕδερόν τε καὶ ἄμφεπον Il. 23.166–7/Il. 24.621–2, similarly τὸν (βοῦν)/τοὺς (βοῦς) δέρον ἀμφί θ' ἕπον Il. 7.316 = Od. 19.421/Od. 8.61.

[15] Thus μέθεπεν/ἔφεπε κρατερώνυχας ἵππους Il. 5.329/Il. 16.724 = 732, cf. *sápanti ... rathirā́saḥ suhástāḥ*, note 5 above); note also ἵππους ἀμφιέποντες ζεύγνυον Il. 19.392, cf. RV. *sápti-* above.

[16] Leaf's work is referred to with approval by Monro, in his contemporaneous edition of the Iliad (in a note on ἕποντα in 6.321), and by van Leeuwen (Enchiridium 1, p.482), who comments that for ἕπω, Leaf "recte observavit activo primitivam vim esse *tractandi, capessendi*"; cf. also Ebeling, Lex. Hom. 1, p.466, who gives "sua arma manibus tractantem" for Il. 6.321, and similarly Cunliffe, Lexicon p.153.

[17] There is no certainty about the interpretation of Myc. *e-we-pe-se-so-me-na* (MY Oe 127: *pa-we-a$_2$ e-we-pe-se-so-me-na* WOOL 2C, Documents^2 p.322), which Palmer derives from *εὐ (i.e. επί) + ἕπω (BICS. 2, 1955, p.44, see also Interpretation p.421: thus 'requiring attention, finishing'), Ventris and Chadwick (loc. cit. and 547, s.v.) from ἕψω 'I boil' (thus 'to be well boiled'), and Beekes (Development p.67) from a hypothetical **eu̯ephō* (i.e. **h$_1$u̯ebh-*, cf. OHG. *weban* etc. 'weave': thus 'to be woven'), later replaced by ὑφαίνω; see Documents^2 p.488 for further discussion. Older etymological conjectures about ἕπω can be ruled out on phonological grounds: e.g. connection with ἅπτω 'I touch' (Leaf, op. cit. p.248ff., similarly Bartholomae, Air. Wb. Sp. 1764), or with ἕψω and Arm. *ep'em* 'cook' (Brugmann, Grdr. 2, 2, p.1021 [1892; but eliminated from the later edition]); see also Leaf's critical comments (op. cit. p.250) on the root **u̯ep-* proposed by Benfey and Savelsberg.

[18] For explicit doubts on semantic grounds, see e.g. Whatmough, Lg. 29 (1953) p.192.

As for *sepeliō*, its original sense 'bury', as opposed to 'cremate', emerges clearly from its use in the Laws of the XII Tables: X. 1: HOMINEM MORTUUM *inquit lex in XII* IN URBE NE SEPELITO NEVE URITO; *credo vel propter ignis periculum. Quod autem addit 'neve urito' indicat non qui uratur sepeliri sed qui humetur*, and X. 9: AT CUI AURO DENTES VINCTI ESCUNT, AST IM CUM ILLO SEPELIET URETVE, SE FRAUDE ESTO.[19] Later usages in which *sepeliō* and its derivatives (e.g. *sepulcrum*) are associated with cremation rites are clearly secondary, as is the metaphorical sense 'overcome' (e.g. *somno sepultus*, and similar expressions). According to Pliny, moreover, *sepeliō* could encompass not just interment per se, but any sort of embalming,[20] and indeed the Roman *funus* in its burial version (just as in its cremation version) is known to have involved all sorts of ritualized manual operations performed on or about the corpse. Thus *sepeliō*[21] itself may well incorporate the notion of 'careful/reverent handling' characteristic of IE. **sep-*. Far from *sepeliō* reflecting a secondary concrete specialization of an abstract 'honor', it is rather the abstract meaning of *saparyáti* that must be accounted for.

In a very few passages, one could conceivably claim that *saparyáti* shows a more primitive physical sense involving manual activity, as when one 'honors' (*saparyáti*) Agni 'with extended ladle', or 'with ghee', or 'with an offering'.[22] But such interpretations are superfluous: meanings like 'honor' or 'serve' are equally appropriate for these passages, and obligatory for *saparyáti* otherwise. Consider also the following facts: (a) *saparyáti* is more than three times as frequent as *sápati* in the Rig-Veda; (b) of the 44 occurrences of *saparyáti* in the Rig-Veda, nearly half are found in Books 1 and 10 (10 × Book 1, 9 × Book 10),

[19] Cic., De leg. 2.23.58 and 2.24.60.

[20] *Sepultus intellegitur quoquo modo conditus, humatus vero humo contectus* (N.H. 7.187).

[21] Or perhaps its presumed nominal basis **sep-el-* or **sep-l̥* (see also Bammesberger, Spr. 28, 1982, p.30 for a possible morphological parallel with Gk. ἀγείρω).

[22] *yatásrucā ... saparyátaḥ* 1.83.3 (here referring to an Adhvaryu, cf. above, note 5), *ghr̥téna ... saparyā́n* 1.72.3, *saparyā́mi práyasā* 3.54.3.

whereas *sápati* occurs only twice in Book 1 and not at all in Book 10; (c) *saparyáti* shows a slightly intensified, but otherwise almost identical predilection for Agni, as compared with *sápati*;[23] (d) *saparyáti* survives into the later language, while *sápati* does not. Renou (BSL. 37, 1936, p. 17 ff.) has documented a number of textual parallels between *sápati* and *saparyáti*, under the assumption that these reflect the primordial identity of the root. But many of these parallels seem to involve mere artistic reminiscences of *sápati* by *saparyáti*, which is entirely consistent with the above facts: note e.g. *ṛtám saparyata* 10.37.1, like *ṛtám sapāmi* 5.12.2 (etc.) discussed in § 2 above.[24] Thus, whatever *saparyáti* may originally have meant, its relatively non-archaic textual behavior in the Rig-Veda shows influence from *sápati*, in its abstract sense 'honor, uphold' etc.[25] There is thus no real obstacle to the assumption that of the pair *saparyáti* : *sepeliō*, it is rather *sepeliō* that preserves something semantically archaic.

§ 5. R. Wallace (Spr. 29, 1983, p. 166) has suggested that Palaic *ša-pa-ú-i-na-i* (and certain other Anatolian forms) may derive from IE. **sep-* 'hold in esteem' (citing Pokorny for the meaning of the root), adding that "[t]he meaning of the Palaic word, 'purifies', is a reasonable extension of the basic meaning suggested by Pokorny". But the above observations on IE. **sep-* call for certain revisions of Wallace's suggestion.

To begin with, Pal. *ša-pa-ú-i-na-i* should not serve as a point of departure for any etymological discussion, since its context is too obscure to allow for certainty as to its meaning: 'purifies' is merely an etymological guess based on other Anatolian material, to be discussed presently.[26]

[23] For *saparyáti*: approx. 48% of its occurences (21/44), versus 43% (6/14) for *sápati*.

[24] Note also the rhyming *saparyávaḥ ... adhvaryávaḥ* 7.2.4 (from the derivative *saparyú-*), cf. *sápanti ... adhvaryávaḥ* 9.97.37, note 5 above.

[25] In this sense, one could say that *saparyáti* holds an "intermediate" position between *sápati* and the demonstrably late Vedic *sévate* 'deals with, honors' (RV. Book 10, AV. +), which developed artifically from the perfect stem *sep-* of *sápati*, as shown by Wackernagel, KZ. 61 (1934) p. 199 ff. = Kl. Schr. p. 360 ff.

[26] For the text, see Carruba, StBoT. 10 (1970) p. 14. Carruba (op. cit. p. 69) glosses *ša-pa-ú-i-na-i* as 'reinigen; säubern (?)', with due caution; cf., in the same text, Pal. *ša-pa-a-ma-an* 'Reinigung (??)' (perhaps also (–)] *šap-pa-ma-an*), and elsewhere Pal. *ša-pa-na-a-an* 'Unb. Bd. oder Ableitung auf *-na-* von *šapa-* "reinigen"' (Carruba, loc. cit.).

Wallace (following Oettinger, Stammbildung p. 535) connects Pal. *ša-pa-ú-i-na-i* with Hitt. *šippāi-* 'scrape off', and further with a Hitt. *šap-* 'id.'. But there are several different forms belonging to Wallace's "Hittite *šap-*" that it would be well to distinguish, especially since, as Oettinger has argued, these forms may not be Hittite at all:

1. Luvian *šappa-* (3 sg. pret. *šap-pa-at-ta* KUB. VIII 50 iii 16, with glossenkeil).[27] The Akkadian version of the Gilgameš passage in which this form occurs confirms the meaning 'he peeled off/scraped off/trimmed' (bark or branches from poles), see Friedrich, JAOS. 88 (1968) p. 38.

2. Luv. *šap(i)ya(i)-* 'scour, scrape clean' (3 sg. pres. *ša-pí-ya-ti-pa-a[t-ta]*, nom. pl. ptcple. *ša-pí-ya-mi-en-zi*, see Laroche, Dict. p. 85; now also *ša-pí-y[a-]ša-an-za*, *ša-p[í-]ya-ti-pa-at-ta*, *ša-pí-ya-im-ma-an* KBo. XXIX 6 Vs. 19', 20', 25', see F. Starke, StBoT. 30, 1985, p. 129).

3. Hitt. *šapiya(i)-* 'cleanse, wash off' (2 sg. imper. *ša-pí-ya-i*, ptcple. *ša-pí-i-ya-an-za* / *ša-pí-a-an-za*). As Friedrich notes, the attestations (all of them occurring in the Tunnawi ritual) are found in parallel with *parkunu-* 'purify';[28] note further the explicit mention of the hand in KUB. XII 58 i 8–9:

ŠU-*TI-KA* da-a nu ku-u-un EN.SISKUR a-pí-e-iz ša-pí-ya-i na-an 12 UZUÚR pár-ku-nu-ut
'Take it [viz. clay] in your hand and cleanse [wipe? rub?] this sacrificer with it, and purify the twelve parts of his body.'

See Oettinger (op. cit. p. 382–83) for arguments in favor of taking the Hitt. *šapiya(i)-* forms as borrowings from Luvian.

4. Hitt. *šappāi-* 'cleanse' (or again possibly 'rub off' vel sim.) (3 sg. pres. *ša-ap-pa-a-iz-zi*, in a Neo-Hitt. medical text, see C. Burde, StBoT. 19, 1974, p. 28).

[27] For the Luvian character of this form, see also Meriggi, Schizzo gramm. dell'anatol. p. 343.

[28] Similarly the morphologically difficult *šappišaraḫḫun* KBo. XV 25 i 9, parallel to *parkununun*; see Friedrich, Heth. Wb., Erg. 3, p. 28.

5. Hitt. *šap-* 'wash' (3 sg. pres. *ša-ap-zi,* pl. *š[a-ap-p]a-an-zi*). For Luvian origin of Hitt. *šappāizi* and *šapzi / šappanzi,* see Oettinger, op. cit. p. 383, 385. For Hitt. *šippāi-* 'shell, peel off' (always with *arḫa*), in contrast, there is no reason to suspect Luvian origin.

For Wallace's "Hittite *šap-*", then, one must speak rather of a Luvian (and partly, although perhaps not originally, Hittite) *šap(p)-,* beside Hitt. *šipp-*.[29] The apparent meanings of these forms, moreover, do not in any way support Wallace's association of a basic meaning 'purify' with the alleged meaning 'hold in esteem' for IE. **sep-*. These verbs clearly refer not to purification in an abstract sense, but to various manual operations, generally in ritual or medical contexts, or, as in the Gilgameš passage, in a technical (but no less physical) context. The Anatolian data, then, are in fact quite consonant with the views expressed above on the meaning of IE. **sep-*;[30] thus Wallace's etymology may well be correct, grosso modo, but not for the reasons he supposed.

As Burde has noted (op. cit. p. 32), there remains a good deal of uncertainty about the precise meanings of some of these forms, which must await a more detailed textual analysis. Note in particular Güterbock's interpretation of *šapzi* as 'hits' (see RHA. 81, 1967, p. 141–42); thus for the phrase LUGAL-*un QA-TE*^{meš}*-ŠU ša-ap-zi* (KUB. XXV 36, passim, e.g. i 13), Güterbock prefers to assume that the priest 'hits the king on his hands', versus Friedrich's[31] 'washes off the king's hands'. A meaning like 'hits' is perhaps still more attractive, as Güterbock points out, for Merzifon fragment 1 (ed. Sayce, JRAS. 1907, p. 921), line 3:[32] [... DUMU].LUGAL ^{giš}PA-*it ša-ap-zi* '[...] hits the [pri]nce with a stick'. Note similarly the phrase GA *š[ap-pa-a]n-zi* in

[29] As is also clear from the above, Wallace's statement that the medial consonants of Pal. *šap-* and Hitt. *šap-* "do not match up", since "Hittite has a fortis stop, Palaic a lenis", is only partly true.

[30] One is particularly reminded of the ritualized meat-preparation usages of Gk. ἔπω.

[31] And others', e.g. Kronasser, Etymol. p. 386; Tischler, Wörterverzeichnis p. 70.

[32] Cited by Güterbock as "Merzifon 2"; I here follow Laroche's designation, see CTH. p. 267.

KUB. XXXIX 45 i 10, which Güterbock takes to mean 'they beat [i.e. churn] milk', with the instrument designated in the next line as *šap-pu-wa-aš* GIŠ-*ru* 'the wood of beating', i.e. a plunger. However this may be, such manual actions of stroking or kneading (in varying degrees of intensity) could as easily be accommodated to the meaning of IE. **sep-* arrived at above as 'wash off' or 'scour', etc., although it would be premature to insist on the etymology at this time.

§ 6. One is tempted, finally, to consider the possibility of deriving Toch. A *sip-* 'salben' (cl. I mid. *siptär*) from IE. **sep-* 'handle (carefully etc.)'. E. Fraenkel's connection with the **seib-* of OHG. *seifa-* 'resin', OE. *sīpian* 'be soaked' etc. (IF. 50, 1932, p. 104) fails to account for the infixed Toch. B pendant *sanāp-* (cl. I mid. *sonoptär*; for the type, cf. *koloktär* 'follows', *woloktär* 'abides'): although the integration of these two forms, to be sure, poses numerous difficulties of interpretation, Toch. B *sanāp-* may at least indicate that the pair (if they are indeed related) need not continue an inherited *i*-diphthong.

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